

the protagonists, which maintains an atmosphere of terror throughout the gameplay. Your only weapon here is a camera, and the only way to fend off ghosts is by pointing the camera towards them and clicking a picture. We remember walking around a home full of ghosts in *Fatal Frame III: The Tormented*, with the precious Camera Obscura, looking around for entities. While some of them were moderately scary, others, especially the spirit of the tattooed woman, was enough to want us to sleep with a nightlight on.

The first three installments of *Fatal Frame* launched for the PlayStation 2 in the years 2001, 2003, and 2005 respectively. The latest offering from the makers, *Fatal Frame: Mask Of The Lunar Eclipse*, was announced recently.

3. Resident Evil 4

One of the greatest games ever belonging to a super-hit franchise, the very mention of *Resident Evil 4* instantly takes us back to the creepy village in Spain where our hero, Leon, is sent to rescue the president's daughter. Right from the first few minutes, you feel invested in the story, even if you haven't played the previous RE games. That's the beauty of this franchise. Even though all of the games are connected to each other, you can still enjoy them as standalone offerings. From having those epic moments in the story to creating an



aura of mystery as well as action throughout, the developers really surprised us back in 2005 with *Resident Evil 4*. Some of these moments included shooting those zombies while being

trapped in a small cabin, trying to take down the zombie with the chainsaw, fighting regenerators and coming across the stunning, Ada Wong.

Owing to its popularity, a remake of the game is also on the way and is expected to be available on PlayStation 5 in 2023. The first game in the *Resident Evil* series released back in 1996, under the name 'Biohazard' in Japan. The latest addition to the franchise, *Resident Evil: Village*, came out last year and proved itself to be worth all the hype.

4. Clock Tower 3

Clock Tower 3 was the first installment of the franchise to launch for the PlayStation 2. The previous *Clock Tower* games launched on the PlayStation and were widely considered to be point and click action adventure games. Even though there were horror elements, they remained limited. However, with *Clock Tower 3*, the developers shifted the game to a pure survival horror genre, resulting in a game that intrigued us with its story while proving to be a bone-chilling experience.

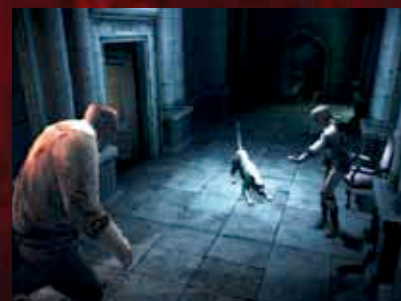
The player takes control of 14-year-old Alyssa, who is living at a boarding school. She receives a letter from her mother, who tells her to go in hiding until her 15th birthday. Alyssa, however, defies her mother's instructions and decides to look for her. The first place that we head to is Alyssa's home, hoping to find her mother there. However, we are greeted by The Dark Gentleman who begins talking in riddles and is honestly creepy. Soon, we find our first bottle of Holy Water. The narrative takes an unexpected turn and we are sent back in time to London, during the second world war. After exploring for a while, we witness our first ghost, a man with a sledgehammer. The game introduces us to several such angry ghosts and the only way to lay them to rest is to returning a particular item to them. The most striking aspect of the gameplay is the way the game goes into 'panic mode' when a spirit is around. Alyssa tosses and tumbles while in panic mode which means the chances

of her being captured by a ghost exceeds. This element of survival horror, along with a rich storyline, is what made *Clock Tower 3* one of the best PS2 horror games.

5. Haunting Ground

Often termed as the 'spiritual successor' to the *Clock Tower* games, *Haunting Ground* is yet another survival horror game that's hard to move on from. The game introduced us to Fiona, who finds herself in the dungeon of a large castle. She soon finds a white dog and names him Hewie. No brownie points for guessing that the castle is full of horrific creatures, one of them being Debilitas, whom we meet early on in the game. In the first few minutes of the game, Fiona is chased by Debilitas who wants to play with her as he thinks she is a doll. As the narrative moves further, Debilitas is stopped (briefly) by Riccardo Belli, the castle's keeper, who isn't what he pretends to be.

Players can draw many similarities between *Clock Tower 3* and *Haunting Ground*, the most prominent being the protagonist losing balance while in panic mode. *Haunting Ground* derived most of its fear through its sound effects. The background score that plays when Fiona is being chased by an enemy, Fiona's footsteps while walking around the castle, the eerie silence in the game which is suddenly disrupted by a chase sequence, and so on. This game remains a hidden gem in the horror world till date and if you were one of the lucky ones who got to



play it back in the PlayStation 2 era, you'd recall it with a smile on your face.

These were some of the best horror games that we experienced on the PlayStation 2. Which one is your favourite? Do let us know. *